

MGT 415: New Venture Development, Elective

Graduate Course, Winter 2026

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OFFICE HOURS: By appointment only
SECTION ID: 999003
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COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course is designed to be an action-based, hands-on “practicum” that aims to equip you with the training and knowledge to assess the viability of a venture idea or early stage venture and develop or grow it into a competitive and sustainable new enterprise or new line of business, whether it is in an entrepreneurial (emerging business – startup or small), intrapreneurial (established business) or social enterprise context. Students can propose a venture, work on a classmate’s venture or choose to work with a campus or community innovator.

Specifically, the course provides instruction, practice, advice and mentoring through hands-on activities, discussion of selected case studies and examples, hypothesis-driven market research, voices of experience, one-on-one advising sessions and team/project immersion time to determine the viability and sustainability of the business concept or opportunity and develop the elements of a value-creating enterprise.

Emphasis will be placed on methods and approaches for conducting customer discovery and business case development, hypothesis-driven lean business model development, and market, financial, and risk evaluation and testing. Deliverables are expected to be data-driven and team-produced. This is a fast-paced course that is intended to take your venture as far as possible or teach you as much about launching a venture as possible.

Students will learn how to perceive needs, foster innovation, and propose unique products or services in a business concept that could satisfy those unmet needs. They will also learn about market segmentation and positioning, as well as market research techniques to test their ideas in a real-world context and to identify potential customers, suppliers and partners. From this they will learn the definition of a business model and how it can represent the key operational design decisions that an organization makes to properly address a market opportunity in a profitable and distinctive manner.

Through case studies, industry examples and discussions, participants will learn the nuances of different business models, challenges, and opportunities faced by entrepreneurs as they evolve their businesses. Students will demonstrate their learning of this material through written and oral presentations.

The course will utilize lectures, case studies, team projects, presentations, individual homework and guest speakers from various innovative industries. The main project and several interim assignments will be completed in your teams. This quarter-length course is designed for upper division undergraduate students.

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the semester, students will have:

- Understand the operational process and disciplines of advanced New Venture Development
- Discern unique differences vital to ensuring the chances of success increase in a new venture
- Synthesize findings about unmet market needs and technology evolution to distinguish viable opportunities from interesting and promising ideas.
- Analyze the financial, human, and technical resources required to capture the market opportunity.
- Demonstrate application of theory and tools from courses in economics and strategy, marketing, finance, operations, communications, management and leadership along with this course in analyzing the business case with supporting data-driven rationale on the commercial viability of the business concept.
- Describe and implement a bootstrapping mentality approach to new venture development.
- Support and present your findings on new ventures as well as critically examine those of others.
- Gain understanding and insights into the overall innovation process of ideation to maturity.
- Identify customer needs and develop value propositions.
- Design and communicate business concepts/models and competitive advantage.
- Project market demand, profit potential and the resources required.
- Assess corporate structures, appropriate tax codes, ensuring the optimal viability and outcome for the new venture development,
- Evaluate growth strategies, valuations and harvesting possibilities.
- Learn about team dynamics, conflict management and group decision making
- Write an executive summary, business plan, new venture pitch and learn techniques for successfully leveraging these tools.
- Learn more about the resources available to entrepreneurs.

MATERIALS

Articles

Students are required to read all articles assigned in the syllabus and be prepared to speak to the main concepts in class discussions. Articles carefully selected to enhance your learning about new venture development, the entrepreneurial venture, and the process.

Textbooks

Several books used for this course.

Good to Great and the Social Sectors, Jim Collins 2005 – Why Business Thinking Is Not The Answer

Ready Set Invest, Daniel Reilly 2024 readyssetinvestbook.com Audiobook version free

Oh, the Places You'll Go! Dr. Theodor Seuss Geisel, January 1990

All materials can be purchased from multiple sources via UCSD, Amazon, or electronically if preferred.

Selected PDF Readings

In order to keep the costs of your education as low as possible, selected pdf reading web or URL links are provided for syllabus reading materials. The majority of articles can easily be found, however URL and website links may be updated from time to time. Students are expected to be able to search the internet using the name of the article, author, etc. to find the article if the noted link is disabled or not working. This is the responsibility of the student.

CLASSROOM PROCEDURE

The course meets 10 times for 2 hours and 50 minutes each time, with 2 short breaks. Class sessions will begin and end on time. If you need to miss a class, please email our TA in advance. Keep in mind class participation is part of your grade.

Make up classes due to University recognized holiday's will be held at a time and in a classroom location to be determined by the Rady School of Management administration. Make up classes may also be remote via Zoom. Make-up class times and locations will be announced in class.

CLASS ASSIGNMENTS

You are expected to read all assignments and prepare answers to the case preparation questions prior to class. Each individual is expected to turn in their own assignments unless they are team projects. Working collaboratively in study groups to discuss the questions prior to completing your own write-up is encouraged.

CLASS AND TEAM PARTICIPATION

Every class session will involve interaction in the form of class discussion. I expect each student to be prepared to comment in any class session. I will randomly (e.g. cold call) on students during the ensuing discussion, both those who raise their hand and those who do not.

EVALUATING CLASS PARTICIPATION

You will be provided a name plaque with your first name by our TA. Please bring the name plaque with you to every class. This allows our guest lecturers, professor, and TA to easily identify you when participating. Class participation will be graded on your readiness, willingness and the quality of your comments and their contribution to the discussion. You are expected to be an active participant throughout the entire class and to contribute to the quality of the discussion.

TEAM PROJECTS

Every student will participate in a team project. Teams will be made up of small groups of approximately 4-5 students depending on class enrollment and areas of focus. You may request your team members (please submit to the TA) otherwise students will be randomly assigned to a team.

The team will be graded as a group. Each team will be responsible for group assignments, as well as a final presentation, Executive Summary, Business Plan. If your team cannot resolve a problem amongst yourselves, please meet with the TA or me. Your team participation will be evaluated by your peers based upon a survey that will be completed by your team members at the end of the quarter.

COMPUTER, DEVICE, & PHONE USAGE IN CLASS

You will be allowed to use your computers in class for note taking purposes only during lectures. Despite the urge to multi-task, this can be distracting to your fellow students. Please use devices in class to help you engage in this class. *No mobile phones or other mobile devices are allowed for use during class.* If you violate this policy, you will be asked to leave the class immediately. Breaks are provided during class to check mobile devices.

VIRTUAL CLASSES

It is possible a class may need to be taught virtually via Zoom due to unforeseen circumstances. If needed, please make sure you watch all Zoom recordings. You are responsible for the material covered in class whether you attend or not.

UNIVERSITY OBSERVED HOLIDAYS

This course may be impacted by university recognized holidays.

STUDENT AMBASSADOR PROGRAM

The student ambassador program is a voluntary program in allowing enrolled students to volunteer for extra credit. The program allows students to serve once as an ambassador to our distinguished CEO guest lecturers.

EXAMINATIONS

You will be required to take exams in this class. Each exam will contain questions about the in-class material (including guest lecturers) and course readings. The exams dates for the quarter are noted in the syllabus. Make-up exams are typically not available. Any exemption requires the written confirmation of the professor via email to the TA and the student.

GRADES

Students will be evaluated based on performance on the following:

Requirement	% of Grade
Class Participation	15%
Homework & Exams	20%
New Venture Project	65%

OFFICE HOURS

I or our class TA will be available weekly by appointment only. Please make appointments in advance by email. Appointment times are available on a first come first served basis. All other office hours will likely be with the course teaching assistant unless other availability permits.

COURSE OUTLINE

Week 1, Class 1 – January 8

Course Introduction, Course Format, Expectations, Grading, Team Projects, etc.

Meet your MGT415 Classmates Discover Entrepreneurial Areas of Passion

Required Reading

- Review Syllabus. Familiarize yourself with course reader & textbooks for the class
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1bumPyvzCyo> – Arnold Schwarzenegger, *Know Where You Are Going*
- “How Will You Measure Your Life?” by Clayton M. Christensen August 2010, Harvard Business Review
- *Ready Set Invest* – Daniel T. Reilly, Pages 1-122

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **Fill out “Final Project Team Interests” on Canvas**
- Project team rosters will be assigned and business plan development will begin after Week 2

Week 2, Class 2 – January 15

Process of Innovation, Problem Solving, Sizing Markets

Guest Lecturer – Dan Reilly, Co-Founder Measured Capital <https://www.linkedin.com/in/danieltreilly/>

Required Reading

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?app=desktop&v=3KG7-cr-y78> - The Effective Executive by Peter F. Drucker Summary by Brian Johnson
- TikTok - <https://fourweekmba.com/tiktok-business-model/>
- *Ready Set Invest* – Daniel T. Reilly, Pages 123-221

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **1 Page Innovation Plan** – Each individual student, fill out each section of the Innovation Plan as if you are TikTok. Each student must use the format provided and submit via Canvas.
- **Network your classmates & begin recruiting members for your team project**
- Project team rosters will be assigned.

Week 3, Class 3 – January 22

Business Concept to New Venture Development, Operating Agreements

Guest Lecturer – Juergen Stark, Chairman of the Board vVardis <https://www.linkedin.com/in/juergenstark/>

Required Reading

- Product Application - <https://www.dentalproductshopper.com/video/how-to-apply-vvardis-curodont-repair-fluoride-plus-on-interproximal-surfaces>
- Review sample templates for operating agreement. Begin formulating ideas for operating agreements if needed, be prepared to discuss in class. <https://www.law.upenn.edu/clinic/entrepreneurship/startupkit/founders-agreement.pdf>
- Podcast - <https://theempirebuilderspodcast.com/149-history-of-franchising-making-millionaires/>

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **1 Page Innovation Plan** – Each individual student, fill out each section of the Innovation Plan for your individual business concept. Answer all questions in detail, turn into Canvas, be prepared to discuss in class.
- **Project Team** – Meet virtually or in person. Each project team member presents their individual business concepts to project team members. Project team members provide questions and feedback for further exploration.

Week 4, Class 4 – January 29

Entrepreneurial Finance – Capital Requirements, Venture Financing, Strategies, Early Startup Decisions

Guest Lecturer – TBD

Required Reading

- Good to Great and the Social Sectors, Jim Collins 2005 – Why Business Thinking Is Not The Answer
- Corporate Culture Architecture - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RocvjvzDI38>
- <https://visible.vc/blog/pitch-deck-vs-business-plan/> The differences, when you need them, what's in them

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **Reading Questions** - Each individual student, answer questions in the format provided via Canvas on Good to Great and the Social Sectors. Each student must use the format provided and submit individual response in Canvas. Be prepared to speak to and explain your answers during class.
- **Project Team** - Fill out 1 page business concept Innovation Model Canvas with final business concept selection
 - o Meet with project team, each individual review and discusses with project team your business concept Innovation Model Canvas. Vote on and select final project team business concept selection.

- Answer, update all questions in detail, turn into Canvas, be prepared to discuss & review with class.

Week 5, Class 5 – February 5

Mid-Semester Business Concept Project Team Pitch

Guest Lecturer – Dr. Ashley Van Zeeland, Illumina <https://www.linkedin.com/in/ashleyvanzeeland/>

Required Reading

- “A Framework to develop a Business Pitch”, <https://slidebean.com/pitch-deck-examples> Review & Reference as needed
- “11 Pitch Deck Examples from Incredibly Successful Companies” <https://www.universitylabpartners.org/blog/11-pitch-deck-examples-from-incredibly-successful-companies>
- “What if your health data could save a life?” Ashley Van Zeeland search TEDxSanDiegoWomen https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MOu8sYPV_EY

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **In class Mid-Year Business Concept Pitch**
 - Each team will present in 1-2 slides in class, maximum 3 minutes. Upload slide presentation to Canvas and nominate a project team lead or lead(s) maximum of (2) to present in class.
 - Class provides feedback to presenting project team during class.
- **Project Team – Check List**
 - Ensure assignments are clear for members of your project team in creating a draft and outline of your business plan.

Week 6, Class 6 – February 12

Obtaining Venture & Growth Capital, Equity Sources, Stock Ownership, Timing, Equity Preservation

No Guest Lecturer - Focused feedback on Project Team Business Concept Pitch & Discussion

Required Reading

- “How Venture Capitalists Make Decisions” An inside look at an opaque process by Paul Gompers, Will Gornall, Steven N. Kaplan and Ilya A. Strebulaev March–April 2021 <https://hbr.org/2021/03/how-venture-capitalists-make-decisions>

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- **Project Team – Each Project Team** - Create a short list of either venture capital, private equity, or alternative source investment firms you will target for your project teams financing.
 - Answer all questions in detail, turn into Canvas, be prepared to discuss in class
- **Project Team – Each Project Team** – Submit a draft of the Executive Summary portion of the business plan
 - Turn into Canvas, be prepared to present and discuss in class
 - Class provides feedback to presenting project team during class

Week 7, Class 7 – February 19

Valuation, Deal Structure, Negotiation

Guest Lecturer – Rory Moore, CEO & Co-Founder Evonex <https://www.linkedin.com/in/moorerory/>

Required Reading

- “Finding the Platform in Your Product” Four strategies that can reveal hidden value by Andrei Hagiu, Elizabeth J. Altman, August 2017 <https://hbr.org/2017/07/finding-the-platform-in-your-product>
- SpaceX, Economies of Scale, and a Revolution in Space Access, Matthew C. Weinzierl, Kylie Lucas and Mehak Sarang https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=4901992
- Credit Insurance - <https://www.jpmorgan.com/insights/treasury/trade-working-capital/does-your-company-need-trade-credit-insurance>

Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class

- Reading Questions - <u>Each individual student</u>, answer questions on SpaceX. Use the format provided and submit via Canvas. Be prepared to speak to and explain your answers during class. - Project Team – <u>Each Project Team</u> – Submit a draft of the Financials portion of the business plan - o Turn into Canvas, be prepared to present and discuss in class - o Class provides feedback to presenting project team during class
Week 8, Class 8 – February 26
Exit Strategies, Mergers & Acquisitions, Liquidity Events
Guest Lecturer – Mike Krenn, Managing Director Prebys Ventures https://www.linkedin.com/in/mikekrenn/
Required Reading
- “How to Write the Perfect Business Plan” by Jeff Haden, Inc. July 20, 2018 https://www.inc.com/jeff-haden/how-to-write-perfect-business-plan-a-comprehensive-guide.html
Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class
- Project Team – <u>Each Project Team</u> – Submit a draft of the section of the business plan your project team wants the most feedback on - o Turn into Canvas, be prepared to present and discuss in class - o Class provides feedback to presenting project team during class
Week 9, Class 9 – March 5
Course Summary, Preparation For Semester Finish
No Guest Lecturer
Required Reading
- “Oh, the Places You’ll Go!” Dr. Theodor Seuss Geisel, January 1990 - “The 7 Key Components of a Perfect Elevator Pitch” https://www.liveplan.com/blog/funding/key-pitch-components?srltid=AfmBOodb7f-8QkbmpF1okHCN4LVg8bEM8GPkPIFp2RZq5h2WQTpjRSi
Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class
- Homework Questions - <u>Each individual student</u> - Each student must use the format provided and submit via Canvas on Mergers & Acquisitions. Be prepared to speak to and explain your answers during class.
Week 10, Class 10 – March 12
Business Plan & Team Project Presentations
Required Reading
- None
Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class
- Each Project Team will upload business plan presentation (1 per team to Canvas) - o Each team will turn in written business plan - Project Team Presentations (email presentation – one per team - at least 3 hours prior to final to the TA so it will be loaded and ready before class begins)
Week 11, Class 11 – March 19
Assignment – To Be Handed In or Submitted Electronically Before Class
- Business plans due by Thursday, March 19th 6:30PM PST or earlier (1 per project team to Canvas)

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As a member of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://senate.uscd.edu/manual/Appendices/Appendix2.pdf>

Citations: You should document/cite sources for all slides in your presentations and deliverables. Be sensitive in considering whether primary sources might want to be named; you can instead provide at title and company or industry. For team analysis based on raw data, please cite the source of the raw data and then “team analysis.” E.g., Bureau of Labor Statistics, Team Analysis. If the entire graphic or analysis came from BLS, then please cite, “Bureau of Labor Statistics.” **Artificial Intelligence:** Use of AI tools such as ChatGPT, Bing Chat, Bard, Claude, etc. is permitted in this class. These tools have considerable potential to streamline and augment our work and you should use them for this class for the purposes of enhancing learning with the following caveats and conditions:

These tools should augment your work, not replace it. For instance, Generative AI tools can improve the quality of your writing, identify new sources, provide high-level summaries of complex ideas or terms, and pressure test your arguments for logical inconsistencies. These tools can help you come up with new ideas, overcome writer's block, or refine your original ideas. You should not use Generative AI tools to generate content that you simply put your name on. This constitutes an academic integrity violation, much like taking another individual's work and misrepresenting it as your own. If you use Generative AI for an assignment, be transparent about if/how it was used in a footnote or citation (e.g., link to the ChatGPT chat you created).

It is the responsibility of each student to ensure that their use of AI tools does not constitute academic misconduct, such as plagiarism or cheating.

Generative AI has documented issues with hallucination and inaccuracy (e.g., generating fake citations, failing logical arguments, misrepresenting sources, etc.). You should assume that anything generated by AI is wrong unless it has been fact-checked by you/verified with an independent reliable source.

If your work does not exceed the baseline quality level produced by AI, you should expect a low grade. You are fully responsible for the content you submit in your assignment.

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.

IMPORTANT DATES

- Instruction begins: Monday, January 5
- Instruction ends: Friday, March 13
- Final exam period: Saturday – Saturday, March 14 – March 21

- Hybrid EMBA Dates: January 10-11, February 7-8, March 7-8

Course **evaluation dates** are standardized and included above. Instructors and students will receive an email when evaluations are opened. Special requests regarding final course evaluations will not be accepted.

- For standard 10-week courses, course evaluations will be open during the last two weeks of instruction (Monday of Week 9 to Friday of Week 10).

Submission of **final grades** will occur through the university's [e-grades system](#). Grade entry for a current quarter opens at 8 a.m. on the first day of finals and closes at 11:59 p.m. on the Tuesday after the last final for the quarter. E-grades submissions dates are available here: [eGrades Dates](#).

General faculty **policies and procedures** for the University of California, San Diego may be found at: <http://blink.ucsd.edu/faculty/index.html>.

If you have any questions or concerns regarding the course details above or the university's policies and procedures, please respond or direct them to gradinstruction@radu.ucsd.edu. Any questions about pending appointments or overload requests can be directed to Rady Academic Personnel at ap@radu.ucsd.edu.

Graduate Instructional Support & Scheduling

office: Wells Fargo Hall 2N116

email: gradinstruction@radu.ucsd.edu

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